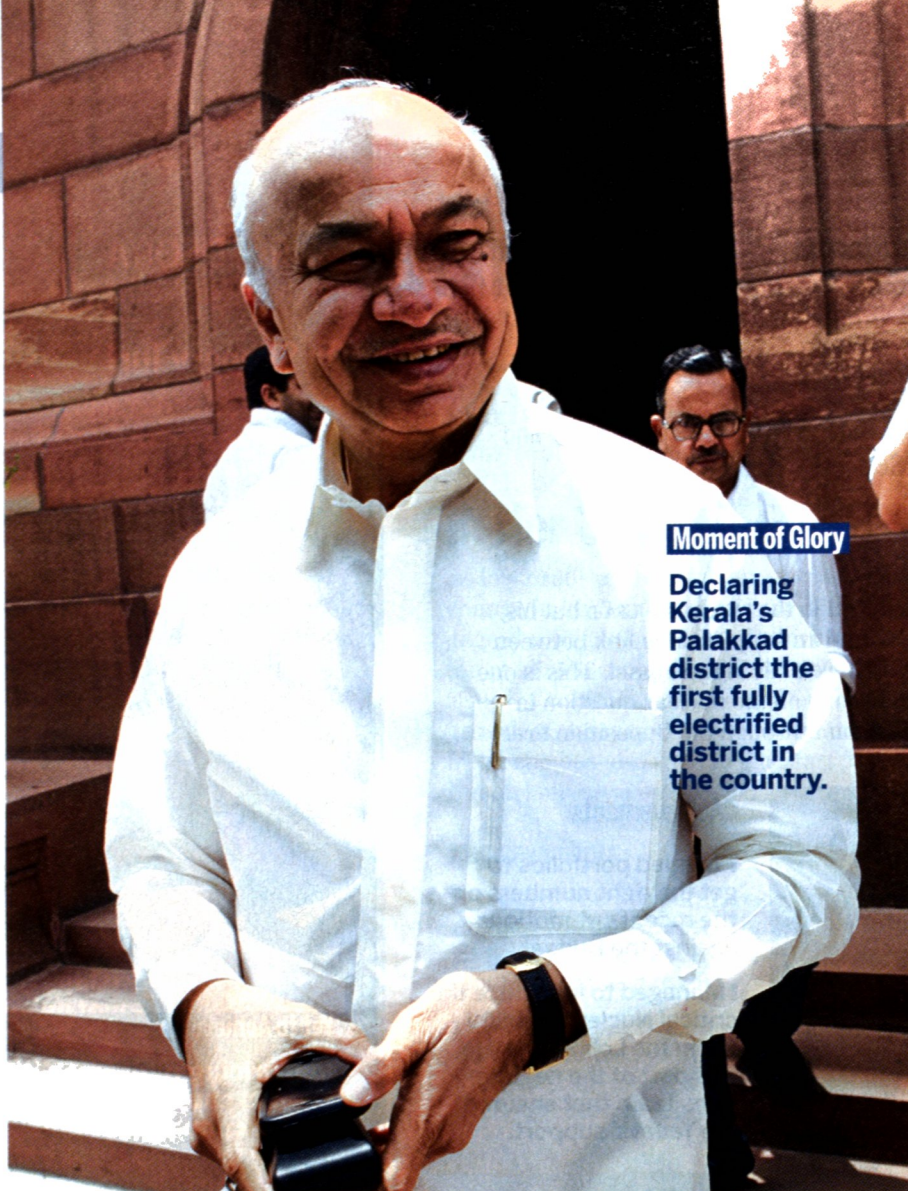




Moment of Glory

Declaring Kerala's Palakkad district the first fully electrified district in the country.

SUSHILKUMAR SHINDE

Minister of Power

Power Point

UPA II saw Shinde in a hyper-charged mode as he worked hard to convert promises into delivery. The "power for all" slogan has seen the highest capacity addition in a single year. In what is seen as a bold initiative, he announced a policy to electrify villages within a 5-km range of Central PSU generation plants so that project-affected people could get reliable power supply.

Achievements

I In 2009-10 alone, over 9,500 mw was added, the highest-ever to be achieved in a single year in the last 60 years.

I Under the Rajiv Gandhi Grameen Vidyutikaran Yojana, over 79,000 villages have been electrified and free electricity has been provided for almost 11 crore BPL households.

Failures

I No focus yet on hurdles in project implementation, delays in environmental clearances as well as dispute resolution mechanisms.

I Power reform programmes as well as transmission and distribution losses are poorly monitored by his ministry.

▼ 49%

B.K. HANDIQUE

Minister of Mines and Development of North Eastern Region

Mr Invisible

He is the least talked about in the Cabinet and fails to make news even in Guwahati. So far his "smartest" move has been a law to regulate the conditionalities for mining of small deposits.



No Show

His promise of a TV channel for North-east to bring the region into the mainstream remains a non-starter.

▼ 32%

PRAFUL PATEL

Minister of State for Civil Aviation

Political Pilot

The dip in Patel's fortunes seem to mirror the meltdown in the aviation sector. The airport development fee has come under fire, as has the Air-India merger. His flip flop on its disinvestment plans ensures Air-India is still the nation's least preferred airline. Being linked to the IPL fracas hasn't helped either as he struggles to regain his lost sheen.

Marquee Moment

The forthcoming July 3 inaugural of Terminal 3 of the Indira Gandhi International Airport.

▼ 32%